impressed by the depth of media analyses and the insightful editorial and opinion pieces. Needless to say, I grew fond of the reporters on the Reserve Bank beat who would follow me on all public events within the country even if they put me in a tight spot more often than I liked. What I found most endearing of all was that they too loved the Reserve Bank as much as those of us inside it did, cared about the institution's reputation and credibility, and rejoiced in its successes and lamented over its setbacks.

Mixed Record

Like on other dimensions, on the communication dimension too my record at the Reserve Bank was a mixed bag. I was largely commended for bringing a culture of openness to a conservative and inward-looking institution, and was complimented for making the bank more transparent, responsive and consultative, for listening as well as speaking, for streamlining our written documents and simplifying our spoken language. In its assessment of my term as governor, titled 'Subbarao—End of a turbulent tenure', the *Hindu BusinessLine* of 3 September 2103 wrote: 'Without providing "sound bites", he still increased the tempo of communication from the central bank and tried to inculcate a culture of transparency. In particular, his attempt to provide "forward guidance" to markets while making it clear that he was retaining his options to act differently, were notable innovations.'

I was both praised for speaking up and derided for not speaking enough when the occasion demanded. I was criticized for showing self-doubt and reticence instead of conveying certainty and confidence, for not staying consistent with the message and for too much straight talk and too little tact. In an article defending my record in the *Business Standard* of 1 June 2011, Abheek Barua's concluding sentences were: 'Markets tend to like uber-confident alpha male central bank governors. Dr. Subbarao was not one. In retrospect, that may turn out to be his biggest flaw.' On the contrary, many others wrote that it was, in fact, my low-key demeanour and low-profile